

Session 28: Glory

Key Takeaways

- Much of the instruction Israel receives is about carving out a space for God's presence to live in their midst.
- God's presence brings reassurance, protection, and guidance, but at this point in the story, it also intensifies the severity of the consequences of rejecting his instruction.
- Exodus is a new creation story—the creation of a new people and a new way for those people to relate to each other and their neighbors.
- Moses' inability to enter the tabernacle introduces a problem, and Leviticus will provide the answer to that problem.

Creation Echoes in the Tabernacle Texts

The author of Exodus signals the creation of a new nation, echoing [Genesis 1-2](#).

- Moses "finished" the work ([Exod. 40:33](#); [Exod. 31:18](#); cf. [Gen. 1:31-2:1](#))
- Moses "saw" the work and approved ([Exod. 39:43](#); [Gen. 1:31](#))
- Moses gave a "blessing" ([Exod. 39:43](#); cf. [Gen. 1:28](#))
- Moses "consecrated" the result ([Exod. 40:9](#); cf. [Gen 2:3](#))

See Mann, Thomas W. (1988). [The Book of the Torah: The Narrative Integrity of the Pentateuch](#). Westminster John Knox Press.

Implications of God's Presence

Much of the instruction Israel receives is about carving out a space for God's presence to live in their midst.

God's presence brings reassurance, protection, and guidance in their travels, but at this point in the story, it also intensifies the severity of the consequences of rejecting his instruction.

Exodus as a Creation Story

The creation of a new nation reshapes the community. The arc of the story takes them from disorder to order, from oppression to love of neighbor, and from serving Pharaoh to serving YHWH.

Their new society is shaped by sacred time (a new calendar), sacred space (YHWH's presence in their midst), and obedience to the covenant stipulations.

Reflection Question

Why was Moses unable to enter after the glory of God filled the tabernacle?